



ARTIFACT DETECTIVE

文物偵探課

Uncover the Secrets of the World's Greatest Artifacts

ICS Creator Academy · Summer 2026



How to Read an Artifact 如何解讀文物

Every artifact tells a story — you just need to know what questions to ask!



LOOK 觀察

- What does it look like?
- What colour, shape, size?
- What is it made of?



THINK 推理

- Who made it? When?
- What was it used for?
- Who owned it?



CONNECT 連結

- What culture is it from?
- What does it tell us?
- Why is it in a museum?

EXHIBIT A



鼻煙盒

Snuff Box

Europe · 17th–18th Century

Rococo Style · 洛可可風格



CASE FILE 案例檔案

WHAT IS IT?



A tiny decorative box — usually gold, silver, or porcelain — used to hold powdered tobacco called 'snuff' 鼻煙. People would take a pinch and sniff it!

WHO USED IT?



European royalty and aristocrats in the 1700s. Owning a beautiful snuff box showed off your wealth and taste. Louis XV of France had over 800!

STYLE CLUE



This one shows Rococo style 洛可可 — soft curves, gold decoration, delicate paintings, and pastel colours. Very fashionable in 18th century France!

FUN FACT



Some snuff boxes had tiny music boxes inside, or secret portraits of lovers hidden under the lid. A tiny treasure chest!



STYLE REPORT: Rococo 洛可可風格解析



Curves & Swirls 曲線與渦旋

No straight lines! Everything curves, swirls, and flows. Like ocean waves frozen in gold.



Nature Motifs 自然圖案

Shells 貝殼, flowers 花卉, leaves 葉子, and vines everywhere. Nature was the main decoration.



Pastel Colours 粉彩色調

Soft pinks, baby blues, mint greens, and creamy whites. Nothing too bright or harsh.



Gold Everywhere 金色裝飾

Gold leaf 金箔 was applied to furniture, picture frames, ceilings — absolutely everywhere!



Playful & Decorative 輕快裝飾

Unlike serious Gothic or grand Baroque, Rococo was meant to feel light, fun, and pleasurable.

FR

Born in France 起源法國

Rococo started in Paris around 1720, in the palaces of King Louis XV. Then spread across Europe.



CASE FILE 案例檔案

WHAT IS IT?



A decorative glass or crystal bottle for storing perfume 香水. These were as important as the perfume inside — sometimes MORE valuable!

HISTORY

FR

France became the perfume capital of the world in the 1600s. The town of Grasse 格拉斯 in southern France is still the perfume centre today.

HOW WAS IT MADE?



The finest bottles were cut crystal 水晶 with gold stoppers. Glassmakers in Venice and Bohemia were the most famous — their techniques were kept secret!

FUN FACT



Cleopatra was one of the first people to use perfume — she reportedly had the sails of her ship soaked in perfume so people could smell her coming from miles away!

EXHIBIT B



香水瓶

Perfume Bottle

France · 18th–19th Century

Crystal & Gold · 水晶與黃金



DETECTIVE CHALLENGE! 偵探挑戰!

Can you solve the mystery? Use your detective skills to figure out what these objects are!

MYSTERY OBJECT



CLUES 線索:

- 🔍 Made of ivory 象牙 or bone 骨頭
- 🔍 Long and thin, fits in a pocket
- 🔍 Used by European gentlemen 1700s

Answer: A toothpick case! 牙籤盒

MYSTERY OBJECT



CLUES 線索:

- 🔍 Small ceramic pot with a lid 陶瓷罐
- 🔍 Found in a lady's bedroom 梳妝台上
- 🔍 Has traces of white powder inside 白色粉末

Answer: A face powder box! 粉盒 (化妝品)

MYSTERY OBJECT



CLUES 線索:

- 🔍 Crystal glass ball 水晶球
- 🔍 Has a long handle 長柄
- 🔍 Used in candlelight 燭光下

Answer: A seal for wax letters! 火漆印章



Small Objects, Big Stories 小文物，大故事

CN

Chinese Snuff Bottle

中國鼻煙壺

Qing Dynasty 清朝

Tiny glass bottles painted INSIDE with a fine brush — one of the most difficult art forms ever created. Artists used bent brushes through the bottle's tiny opening!

JP

Japanese Netsuke

日本根付

Edo Period 江戶時代

Tiny carved toggles 小雕刻 made of ivory or wood, used to hang pouches from kimonos. Each one tells a story — animals, mythology, daily life.

RU

Fabergé Egg

法貝熱彩蛋

1885–1917 AD

Jewelled eggs made for Russian Tsars. Each one opened to reveal a tiny surprise inside. Only 50 survive — each worth millions of dollars today!

EG

Egyptian Amulet

埃及護身符

Ancient Egypt 古埃及

Small charms worn to protect against evil spirits. The Eye of Horus 荷魯斯之眼 was the most popular — Egyptians even put them inside mummies!



CASE CLOSED! 案件結案！

You've solved today's artifact mysteries! 你完成了今天的文物解謎！



Every object was once someone's treasure — it tells us how they lived.



A good detective asks: WHO made it? WHEN? WHY? For whom?



Small objects can reveal big things about culture, wealth, and daily life.



When we visit museums, we are reading history written in objects.